- Prosthetics: to provide guidance in obtaining artificial limbs or a device like an artificial hearing aid
- Vocational guidance: the parent must be educated and convoked that the child can be restored to function as a useful member. Such vocational guidance, as it is called, is given in several schools in India.
  - Occupational and Physical Therapy school at Mumbai
  - Occupational Therapy School at Nagpur
  - All – India Institute of Physical Medicine and Rehabilitation, Mumbai
  - Institute of Physical Medicine and Rehabilitation, Christian Medical College and Hospital, Vellore

Besides these, there are schools specifically for the deaf and dumb, and for the blind, which are run by private organizations and by government.

- Preventive activities: Preventive steps can be adopted to limit the extent of disability. Some disabilities, e.g., due to polio or accidents can be prevented. Adequate nutrition can be maintained, so that mental retardation due to malnutrition can be prevented
- Education: Nurse can arrange for community education on the above aspects to enlighten the people. Specially, in India people associate the mishaps to 'fate' or curse from God. So guiding them in the right way is essential

Interdisciplinary approach in providing care to the disabled by the home health nurse

- Families are often the primary care givers of family members who are disabled. It is important to identify strategies that promote family functioning, stability, growth, and coping
- Nursing interventions should include assessing the entire family as a unit of care
- Nurses need to assess their personal feelings, which can inhibit or enhance their ability to function effectively with persons who are disabled
- Nurses focus on preventive strategies for people who already have potentially disabling conditions to limit the occurrences, impairment and functional limitation
- Nurses promote self care, self management and self advocacy
- Nurses provide health education interventions which include teaching clients about their conditions, community resources, self management, self care and self advocacy
- Nurses assist clients in learning how to find and utilize community resources

Mental Retardation

Mental retardation is a condition of both clinical and social importance. It is characterized by limitations in performance that result from significant impairments in measured intelligence and adaptive behaviour.

Mental retardation is defined as:

- Significantly sub average general intellectual functioning (IQ below 70)
- Significantly deficit or impairment in adaptive functioning
- Which manifests during the period of development (before 18 years of age)

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